

Post-incident review PIR-2026-034

Customer Portal: degraded latency

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 30 April 2026, Customer Portal experienced degraded latency in production (AU East) for about 110 minutes. A scripted sign-in probe started failing from two regions. Investigation found that the autoscaler reached its maximum instance count during a traffic peak.

Impact

Users of Customer Portal saw degraded latency for about 110 minutes. The service owner, Digital Channels, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:18 First signal received.
- 09:36 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:42 Likely cause identified.
- 10:24 Mitigation applied.
- 10:41 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the autoscaler reached its maximum instance count during a traffic peak.

Certificates were checked as part of triage and were valid.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

There was no documented procedure for this failure mode, so responders worked it out live.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Add a pre-deployment check that validates the setting against the production baseline.
- Write and rehearse a runbook for this failure mode.
- Add a circuit breaker and timeout on the upstream call.